

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Indian Diaspora, Consular Protection and Soft Power - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Indian Diaspora, Consular Protection and Soft Power	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01	FOUNDATION — WHAT THIS DIASPORA OWNER HOLDS AND HOW ITS BOUNDARIES ARE Technically, FOUNDATION — What this diaspora owner holds and
02	FOUNDATION — FOUR CATEGORIES AND THE EXACT STATUS OF EVERY NUMBER Evidence chain: The diaspora categories and the exact status of every
03	FOUNDATION — WHAT OVERSEAS CITIZEN OF INDIA STATUS IS AND IS NOT Evidence chain: Overseas Citizen of India status and the citizenship
04	CORE — THE DATED CONVENING INSTRUMENT AND ITS HONEST SILENCE Evidence chain: Pravasi Bharatiya Divas as the dated convening
05	CORE — THE GRIEVANCE PORTAL AND THE WELFARE STACK BEHIND IT Evidence chain: The MADAD grievance portal and its successor
06	CORE — THE CLEARANCE CATEGORY AS THE LEGAL HINGE OF PROTECTION Evidence chain: The Protector General of Emigrants and the clearance
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08	CORE — CASELOAD, SCALE AND THE HONEST READING OF BOTH Evidence chain: Consular caseload as a scale indicator - Operation
09	CORE — REMITTANCES AS LINKAGE, NOT AS THE POLITICAL ANSWER The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest
10	CORE — THE COMPOSITION SHIFT AND THE INSTRUMENT MISMATCH IT EXPOSES The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing
11	CORE — THE SOFT-POWER INVENTORY IN THE SOURCE'S OWN TERMS Evidence chain: The soft-power inventory in the source's own terms
12	CORE — NOW-REQUIRED-INDIANS AS A CONDITIONAL POLICY ARGUMENT Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians
13	CORE SYNTHESIS — FRAGMENTATION AND AUTHENTICITY AS THE TWO INTERNAL Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done
14	CORE SYNTHESIS — TECHNICAL COOPERATION, ITS CULTURAL ROLE AND ITS REGIONAL LIMIT Evidence chain: Technical cooperation as cultural diplomacy and its
15	CORE SYNTHESIS — POLITICAL INFLUENCE, ITS LIMITS AND HONEST QUESTION OWNERSHIP Evidence chain: Political influence and the liability side of the same

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this diaspora owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. B. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. C. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. D. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away.

Answer: A. Explanation: This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q2. Which card should be filed under What this diaspora owner holds and how its boundaries are routed in an International Relations answer?

A. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. B. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. C. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. D. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on.

Answer: B. Explanation: This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this diaspora owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. B. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. C. This topic owns the

diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. D. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away.

Answer: C. Explanation: This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this diaspora owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. B. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. C. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. D. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and

citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06.

Answer: D. Explanation: This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The diaspora categories and the exact status of every figure?

A. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. B. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. C. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. D. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q6. Which card should be filed under The diaspora categories and the exact status of every figure in an International Relations answer?

A. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. B. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. C. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. D. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The diaspora categories and the exact status of every figure?

A. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. B. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. C. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External

Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. D. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The diaspora categories and the exact status of every figure?

A. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. B. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. C. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. D. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens

abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Overseas Citizen of India status and the citizenship boundary?

A. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. B. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. C. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. D. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q10. Which card should be filed under Overseas Citizen of India status and the citizenship boundary in an International Relations answer?

A. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. B. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. C. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. D. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Overseas Citizen of India status and the citizenship boundary?

A. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. B. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. C. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. D. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on

2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Overseas Citizen of India status and the citizenship boundary?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. B. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. C. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. D. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Pravasi Bharatiya Divas as the dated convening instrument?

A. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. B. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. C. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. D. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things.

Answer: A. Explanation: Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q14. Which card should be filed under Pravasi Bharatiya Divas as the dated convening instrument in an International Relations answer?

A. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. B. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. C. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required

categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. D. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things.

Answer: B. Explanation: Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pravasi Bharatiya Divas as the dated convening instrument?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. B. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. C. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. D. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments.

Answer: C. Explanation: Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an

undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pravasi Bharatiya Divas as the dated convening instrument?

A. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. B. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. C. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. D. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away.

Answer: D. Explanation: Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The MADAD grievance portal and its successor version?

A. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. B. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning

Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. C. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. D. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things.

Answer: A. Explanation: MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q18. Which card should be filed under The MADAD grievance portal and its successor version in an International Relations answer?

A. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. B. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. C. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. D. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation

rather than as a criticism of the community.

Answer: B. Explanation: MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The MADAD grievance portal and its successor version?

A. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. B. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. C. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. D. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community.

Answer: C. Explanation: MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The MADAD grievance portal and its successor version?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. B. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. D. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies The welfare stack behind the portal?

A. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. B. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. C. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. D. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963

and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release.

Answer: A. Explanation: Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q22. Which card should be filed under The welfare stack behind the portal in an International Relations answer?

A. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. B. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. C. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. D. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community.

Answer: B. Explanation: Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and

permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The welfare stack behind the portal?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. C. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. D. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06.

Answer: C. Explanation: Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The welfare stack behind the portal?

A. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. B. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that

generates such crises belongs to topic 06. C. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. D. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things.

Answer: D. Explanation: Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies The Protector General of Emigrants and the clearance category?

A. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. B. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. C. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. D. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q26. Which card should be filed under The Protector General of Emigrants and the clearance category in an International Relations answer?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. B. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. D. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Protector General of Emigrants and the clearance category?

A. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. B. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare

because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. C. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. D. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Protector General of Emigrants and the clearance category?

A. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. B. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. D. The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for

Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies The consular treaty frame and what Article 36 actually guarantees?

A. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. C. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. D. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06.

Answer: A. Explanation: The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q30. Which card should be filed under The consular treaty frame and what Article 36 actually guarantees in an International Relations answer?

A. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. B. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. D. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight.

Answer: B. Explanation: The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The consular treaty frame and what Article 36 actually guarantees?

A. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year

2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. C. The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. D. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment.

Answer: C. Explanation: The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The consular treaty frame and what Article 36 actually guarantees?

A. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. B. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. C. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. D. The

United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release.

Answer: D. Explanation: The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Consular caseload as a scale indicator?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. C. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. D. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the

community. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q34. Which card should be filed under Consular caseload as a scale indicator in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. B. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. C. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. D. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Consular caseload as a scale indicator?

A. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. B. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. C. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a

measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. D. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Consular caseload as a scale indicator?

A. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. B. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. C. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. D. The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Operation Sindhu and the evacuation-diplomacy boundary?

A. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. C. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. D. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q38. Which card should be filed under Operation Sindhu and the evacuation-diplomacy boundary in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. B. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. C. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled

Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. D. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment.

Answer: B. Explanation: Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Operation Sindhu and the evacuation-diplomacy boundary?

A. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. B. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. C. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. D. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer.

Answer: C. Explanation: Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Operation Sindhu and the evacuation-diplomacy boundary?

A. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. B. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. C. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. D. Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06.

Answer: D. Explanation: Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Remittances as a diplomatic linkage and the Economy boundary?

A. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. B. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. C. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument

that does not reach that segment. D. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q42. Which card should be filed under Remittances as a diplomatic linkage and the Economy boundary in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. C. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. D. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Remittances as a diplomatic linkage and the Economy boundary?

A. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. B. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. D. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Remittances as a diplomatic linkage and the Economy boundary?

A. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. B. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. C. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. D. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD

135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies The remittance composition shift and what it changes?

A. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. B. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. C. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. D. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q46. Which card should be filed under The remittance composition shift and what it changes in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. B. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. C. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. D. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The remittance composition shift and what it changes?

A. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. B. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. C. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. D. Tharoor argues

that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The remittance composition shift and what it changes?

A. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. B. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. D. The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The instrument-population mismatch?

A. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. B. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. C. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. D. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q50. Which card should be filed under The instrument-population mismatch in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. B. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. C. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. D. Tharoor reframes

Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The instrument-population mismatch?

A. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. B. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. C. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. D. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The instrument-population mismatch?

A. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. C. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. D. The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The soft-power inventory in the source's own terms?

A. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. B. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. C. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and

must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. D. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q54. Which card should be filed under The soft-power inventory in the source's own terms in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. B. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. D. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The soft-power inventory in the source's own terms?

A. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. B. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. C. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. D. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The soft-power inventory in the source's own terms?

A. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. B. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed

per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. C. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. D. Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Now-Required-Indians as a conditional policy argument?

A. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. B. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. C. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. D. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and

the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q58. Which card should be filed under Now-Required-Indians as a conditional policy argument in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. B. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. C. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. D. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Now-Required-Indians as a conditional policy argument?

A. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. C. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. D. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Now-Required-Indians as a conditional policy argument?

A. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims

ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. B. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. C. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. D. Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor reframes Non-Resident Indians as Now-Required-Indians while arguing that India lacks a policy to channel diaspora enthusiasm, commitment and resources to the promotion of India's image, and the owners stress that the reframing is explicitly conditional on India adopting such a policy rather than being a description of the diaspora's current relationship with India; the answer-writing consequence is that the phrase must be deployed as a policy-design argument with its condition attached, since quoting it as a settled description inverts the author's own claim. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies The institutional-fragmentation critique?

A. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. B. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and

final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. D. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q62. Which card should be filed under The institutional-fragmentation critique in an International Relations answer?

A. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. B. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. C. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. D. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger

records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The institutional-fragmentation critique?

A. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. B. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. C. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. D. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief

and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The institutional-fragmentation critique?

A. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. B. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. C. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. D. Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Authenticity and self-inflicted soft-power damage?

A. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. C. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. D. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q66. Which card should be filed under Authenticity and self-inflicted soft-power damage in an International Relations answer?

A. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. B. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. C. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. D. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Authenticity and self-inflicted soft-power damage?

A. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. B. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. C. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. D. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Authenticity and self-inflicted soft-power damage?

A. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. B. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. C. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. D. Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Technical cooperation as cultural diplomacy and its regional limit?

A. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. B. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party,

constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. C. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. D. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q70. Which card should be filed under Technical cooperation as cultural diplomacy and its regional limit in an International Relations answer?

A. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so

the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. C. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. D. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Technical cooperation as cultural diplomacy and its regional limit?

A. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. B. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. D. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian

population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Technical cooperation as cultural diplomacy and its regional limit?

A. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. B. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. C. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. D. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Political influence and the liability side of the same asset?

A. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. B. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. C. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. D. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06.

Answer: A. Explanation: Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q74. Which card should be filed under Political influence and the liability side of the same asset in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. B. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. C. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. D. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06.

Answer: B. Explanation: Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Political influence and the liability side of the same asset?

A. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. B. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. C. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. D. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away.

Answer: C. Explanation: Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Political influence and the liability side of the same asset?

A. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. B. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to

the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. C. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. D. Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community.

Answer: D. Explanation: Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Honest question ownership for this diaspora owner?

A. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. B. This topic owns the diaspora as a foreign-policy relationship: the population categories and their exact legal status, the welfare and consular-protection stack, evacuation diplomacy as distinct from evacuation logistics, remittances treated only as a diplomatic linkage, and the cultural soft-power track running through the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme and India's cultural assets; its distinctive feature is that the same population is simultaneously an asset, a standing protection obligation and a potential source of host-country friction, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020 and 2023 are routed here with no objective demand routed at all, while Overseas Citizen of India and citizenship doctrine belongs to the Polity owner, remittance macroeconomics

belongs to the Economy owner, relief and logistics belong to the Disaster Management owners, and Gulf-specific regional exposure belongs to topic 06. C. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. D. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments.

Answer: A. Explanation: The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q78. Which card should be filed under Honest question ownership for this diaspora owner in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. B. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. C. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition

officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. D. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on.

Answer: B. Explanation: The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Honest question ownership for this diaspora owner?

A. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. B. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. C. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. D. The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on.

Answer: C. Explanation: The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Honest question ownership for this diaspora owner?

A. MADAD is the Ministry of External Affairs online grievance-redress and consular-assistance platform for overseas Indians, launched on 21 February 2015, and MADAD 2.0 was launched in December 2025 and linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras; the owners treat this as the routine consular limb of the relationship, qualitatively different from crisis evacuation, and they insist that a platform launch is evidence of an available channel rather than evidence of a resolved grievance, so an answer should cite it as institutional capacity and not as an outcome. B. Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. C. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. D. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred.

Answer: D. Explanation: The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the

mark value; no objective demand from any audited Prelims ledger is routed to this owner. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in South-East Asian economy and society, which falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers, is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, and is therefore recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number rather than being converted into a solved card; no option, answer letter or unverified stem is recorded or inferred. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Two General Studies Paper II Mains demands are routed to this topic in the audited routing ledgers and each is reproduced below as a demand card with its printed year, paper, question number, directive, marks and word limit exactly as the ledger records them: 2020 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and European countries, a Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words, for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership; and 2023 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits, a Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words on the same superseding route, for which the ledger records that the word limit was taken from the paper's instruction block because the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value, a provenance defect that is reported here rather than repaired by invented wording. No objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. The Basic and Advanced owners additionally cite a 2017 General Studies Paper II demand on the role of the Indian diaspora in the economy and society of South-East Asian countries; that year falls outside the audited 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 routing ledgers and the wording is not confirmable from the locally held official papers, so it is recorded here as an owner-cited demand without a question number and is deliberately not converted into a solved demand card. The Basic and Advanced owners also record that no General Studies Paper II Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers directly names the diaspora, consular protection or soft power, and that absence is stated honestly instead of force-fitting an adjacent question. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm the printed wording of the two routed Mains demands; no question was invented from them, no stem was paraphrased into an apparent routing, and no marking scheme or official answer key was imported.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- FACT: **2017 GS-II**: "Indian diaspora has an important role to play in South-East Asian countries' economy and society. Appraise the role of Indian diaspora in South-East Asia in this context." - separate economic contribution, social mediation and host-country constraints.
- FACT: **2020 GS-II**: "Indian diaspora has a decisive role to play in the politics and economy of America and European countries. Comment with examples." - distinguish political influence from economic contribution; do not substitute remittance data for the political half.
- ANALYSIS: No 2024-2025 question directly names the diaspora; use the 18th PBD as the current anchor, Polity for OCI doctrine and Economy for remittances.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2020, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	GS-II	10	Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and Europe	Comment with examples · 10 marks · 150 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-II	10	Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits	Describe · 10 marks · 150 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and Europe
- Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **FACT: 2017 GS-II** requires an appraisal of the diaspora's economic and social role in South-East Asia; apply the two-way-bridge model and add host-country integration/identity constraints.
- **FACT: 2020 GS-II** requires comment on the diaspora's political and economic role in America and Europe; keep lobbying/representation analytically distinct from trade, entrepreneurship and knowledge networks.
- **ANALYSIS:** No 2024-2025 question directly names this theme. An advanced answer should:
 1. Distinguish the welfare/protection track from the soft-power-projection track explicitly.
 2. Cite Tharoor's institutional-fragmentation critique as the analytical spine for any "how should India improve its soft power" question.
 3. Link authenticity/pluralism at home to credibility abroad, using the nativist-attack example as concrete evidence.
 4. Cite the dated PBD (January 2025) rather than an undated diaspora-engagement claim.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2020, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	GS-II	10	Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and Europe	Comment with examples · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-II	10	Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits	Describe · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic; word limit taken from the instruction block	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Indian diaspora in the politics and economy of America and Europe
- Indian diaspora in the West and its economic and political benefits

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper II Question 10

Demand: 'Indian diaspora has a decisive role to play in the politics and economy of America and European Countries'. Comment with examples. (Answer in 150 words). A Comment with examples demand of 10 marks and 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger and confirmed against the locally held official paper.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the diaspora's role is substantial and demonstrable in the economic sphere and real but conditional in the political sphere, so the word decisive overstates the political limb while understating how the two limbs interact. Named evidence and example: the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026, recording 35,421,987 overseas Indians of whom 19,571,375 are Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 are Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221; the Economic Survey 2025-26 record of India as the world's largest recipient of remittances at USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026; the Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, showing advanced economies now contributing more than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries with the United States at 27.7 per cent, the United Kingdom at 10.8 per cent and Singapore at 6.6 per cent; Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024; six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives in the 119th Congress; and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifying Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies. Analysis: the economic limb is decisive in a measurable sense because remittances, professional presence and knowledge networks change the composition of India's external accounts and the density of its institutional links with these societies, while the political limb works indirectly through access, familiarity and coalition-building rather than through control, so the diaspora enlarges the space in which Indian diplomacy operates without determining any specific legislative or electoral outcome; the shift of the remittance base towards advanced economies makes precisely these host relationships more consequential for consular and negotiating purposes. Qualification: the comment must not overstate the political limb, because office-holders of Indian origin act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, party, constituency and committee incentives shape their positions more than ancestry does, diaspora advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval of the civil-nuclear initiative, diaspora-linked security or separatism disputes can convert a community connection into a sovereignty and law-enforcement problem, and every population figure cited is a stock estimate rather than a count of citizens or of Overseas Citizen of India cards. Why this earns marks: it engages the word decisive directly instead of ignoring it, evidences both halves of the question with dated and named material, and closes with the host-country mandate limit that separates influence from control.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper II Question 10", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the diaspora's role is substantial and demonstrable in the economic sphere and real but conditional in the political sphere, so the word decisive overstates the political limb while understating how the two limbs interact. Named evidence and example: the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026, recording 35,421,987 overseas Indians of whom 19,571,375 are Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 are Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221; the Economic Survey 2025-26 record of India as the world's largest recipient of remittances at USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026; the Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, showing advanced economies now contributing more than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries with the United States at 27.7 per cent, the United Kingdom at 10.8 per cent and Singapore at 6.6 per cent; Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024; six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives in the 119th Congress; and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifying Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies. Analysis: the economic limb is decisive in a measurable sense because remittances, professional presence and knowledge networks change the composition of India's external accounts and the density of its institutional links with these societies, while the political limb works indirectly through access, familiarity and coalition-building rather than through control, so the diaspora enlarges the space in which Indian diplomacy operates without determining any specific legislative or electoral outcome; the shift of the remittance base towards advanced economies makes precisely these host relationships more consequential for consular and negotiating purposes. Qualification: the comment must not overstate the political limb, because office-holders of Indian origin act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, party, constituency and committee incentives shape their positions more than ancestry does, diaspora advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval of the civil-nuclear initiative, diaspora-linked security or separatism disputes can convert a community connection into a sovereignty and law-enforcement problem, and every population figure cited is a stock estimate rather than a count of citizens or of Overseas Citizen of India cards. Why this earns marks: it engages the word decisive directly instead of ignoring it, evidences both halves of the question with dated and named material, and closes with the host-country mandate limit that separates influence from control.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper II Question 10 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the diaspora's role is substantial and demonstrable in the economic sphere and real but conditional in the political sphere, so the word decisive overstates the political limb while understating how the two limbs interact. Named evidence and example: the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026, recording 35,421,987 overseas Indians of whom 19,571,375 are Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 are Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221; the Economic Survey 2025-26 record of India as the world's largest recipient of remittances at USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026; the Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, showing advanced economies now contributing more than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries with the United States at 27.7 per cent, the United Kingdom at 10.8 per cent and Singapore at 6.6 per cent; Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as

United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024; six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives in the 119th Congress; and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifying Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies. Analysis: the economic limb is decisive in a measurable sense because remittances, professional presence and knowledge networks change the composition of India's external accounts and the density of its institutional links with these societies, while the political limb works indirectly through access, familiarity and coalition-building rather than through control, so the diaspora enlarges the space in which Indian diplomacy operates without determining any specific legislative or electoral outcome; the shift of the remittance base towards advanced economies makes precisely these host relationships more consequential for consular and negotiating purposes. Qualification: the comment must not overstate the political limb, because office-holders of Indian origin act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, party, constituency and committee incentives shape their positions more than ancestry does, diaspora advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval of the civil-nuclear initiative, diaspora-linked security or separatism disputes can convert a community connection into a sovereignty and law-enforcement problem, and every population figure cited is a stock estimate rather than a count of citizens or of Overseas Citizen of India cards. Why this earns marks: it engages the word decisive directly instead of ignoring it, evidences both halves of the question with dated and named material, and closes with the host-country mandate limit that separates influence from control.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper II Question 10", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 General Studies Paper II Question 10

Demand: Indian diaspora has scaled new heights in the West. Describe its economic and political benefits for India. A Describe demand of 10 marks and 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger and confirmed against the locally held official paper, where the printed per-question tail carries only the mark value and the word limit is taken from the paper's instruction block.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed, and the word-limit provenance is reported rather than reconstructed.

Model solution: Claim: the diaspora's rise in the West yields three describable benefit streams for India, namely financial inflows, knowledge and institutional networks, and political access, and each is real, dated and separately bounded. Named evidence and example: the financial stream is evidenced by the Economic Survey 2025-26 record of India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025 at about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and by the Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024 showing the United States at 27.7 per cent, the United Arab Emirates at 19.2 per cent, the United Kingdom at 10.8 per cent and Singapore at 6.6 per cent; the network stream is evidenced by a diaspora of 35,421,987 recorded by the Ministry of External Affairs as on January 2026, including 6,079,221 in the United States, and by Tharoor's inclusion of the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora among the components of India's soft power alongside educational opportunities, health care, cultural schemes, Ayurveda and yoga; the political stream is evidenced by Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025, Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, six Indian-American members of the House in the 119th Congress, and organisational advocacy around the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative. Analysis: the three streams reinforce one another, since professional success generates both remittances and reputational capital, reputational capital lowers the cost of India's own cultural and technical diplomacy, and visibility in host institutions creates access that converts diplomatic requests into hearings rather than into outcomes; the composition shift towards advanced economies also raises the consular and negotiating weight of exactly the countries where the diaspora is most prominent, which is why benefit and obligation grow together. Qualification: the description must remain bounded, because population figures are

stock estimates and not counts of citizens or Overseas Citizen of India cards, Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship, remittance data evidences economic weight and cannot be substituted for political effect, host-country office-holders act under their own mandates, the same prominence creates a protection obligation evidenced by 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad recorded in a Lok Sabha answer of 28 March 2025, and India's soft power can be damaged by domestic conduct inconsistent with the plural, multi-religious and multi-linguistic self-image the source insists upon. Why this earns marks: it describes three distinct benefit streams with precise dated evidence rather than listing achievements, links them causally, and closes by converting the benefit into the obligation that a strong conclusion needs.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 General Studies Paper II Question 10", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the diaspora's rise in the West yields three describable benefit streams for India, namely financial inflows, knowledge and institutional networks, and political access, and each is real, dated and separately bounded. Named evidence and example: the financial stream is evidenced by the Economic Survey 2025-26 record of India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025 at about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and by the Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024 showing the United States at 27.7 per cent, the United Arab Emirates at 19.2 per cent, the United Kingdom at 10.8 per cent and Singapore at 6.6 per cent; the network stream is evidenced by a diaspora of 35,421,987 recorded by the Ministry of External Affairs as on January 2026, including 6,079,221 in the United States, and by Tharoor's inclusion of the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora among the components of India's soft power alongside educational opportunities, health care, cultural schemes, Ayurveda and yoga; the political stream is evidenced by Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025, Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, six Indian-American members of the House in the 119th Congress, and organisational advocacy around the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative. Analysis: the three streams reinforce one another, since professional success generates both remittances and reputational capital, reputational capital lowers the cost of India's own cultural and technical diplomacy, and visibility in host institutions creates access that converts diplomatic requests into hearings rather than into outcomes; the composition shift towards advanced economies also raises the consular and negotiating weight of exactly the countries where the diaspora is most prominent, which is why benefit and obligation grow together. Qualification: the description must remain bounded, because population figures are stock estimates and not counts of citizens or Overseas Citizen of India cards, Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship, remittance data evidences economic weight and cannot be substituted for political effect, host-country office-holders act under their own mandates, the same prominence creates a protection obligation evidenced by 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad recorded in a Lok Sabha answer of 28 March 2025, and India's soft power can be damaged by domestic conduct inconsistent with the plural, multi-religious and multi-linguistic self-image the source insists upon. Why this earns marks: it describes three distinct benefit streams with precise dated evidence rather than listing achievements, links them causally, and closes by converting the benefit into the obligation that a strong conclusion needs.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 General Studies Paper II Question 10 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the diaspora's rise in the West yields three describable benefit streams for India, namely financial inflows, knowledge and institutional networks, and political access, and each is real, dated and

separately bounded. Named evidence and example: the financial stream is evidenced by the Economic Survey 2025-26 record of India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025 at about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and by the Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024 showing the United States at 27.7 per cent, the United Arab Emirates at 19.2 per cent, the United Kingdom at 10.8 per cent and Singapore at 6.6 per cent; the network stream is evidenced by a diaspora of 35,421,987 recorded by the Ministry of External Affairs as on January 2026, including 6,079,221 in the United States, and by Tharoor's inclusion of the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora among the components of India's soft power alongside educational opportunities, health care, cultural schemes, Ayurveda and yoga; the political stream is evidenced by Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025, Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, six Indian-American members of the House in the 119th Congress, and organisational advocacy around the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative. Analysis: the three streams reinforce one another, since professional success generates both remittances and reputational capital, reputational capital lowers the cost of India's own cultural and technical diplomacy, and visibility in host institutions creates access that converts diplomatic requests into hearings rather than into outcomes; the composition shift towards advanced economies also raises the consular and negotiating weight of exactly the countries where the diaspora is most prominent, which is why benefit and obligation grow together. Qualification: the description must remain bounded, because population figures are stock estimates and not counts of citizens or Overseas Citizen of India cards, Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship, remittance data evidences economic weight and cannot be substituted for political effect, host-country office-holders act under their own mandates, the same prominence creates a protection obligation evidenced by 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad recorded in a Lok Sabha answer of 28 March 2025, and India's soft power can be damaged by domestic conduct inconsistent with the plural, multi-religious and multi-linguistic self-image the source insists upon. Why this earns marks: it describes three distinct benefit streams with precise dated evidence rather than listing achievements, links them causally, and closes by converting the benefit into the obligation that a strong conclusion needs.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 General Studies Paper II Question 10", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Comment with examples on the proposition that the Indian diaspora has a decisive role to play in the politics and economy of America and European countries. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Decisive is a strong word that the evidence only partly supports, so the comment must separate economic contribution from political effect, evidence both with named cases and figures, and then qualify the political limb with host-country mandate and incentive constraints.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community.

- The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight.
- The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment.
- The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments.

Qualified conclusion: Decisive is a strong word that the evidence only partly supports, so the comment must separate economic contribution from political effect, evidence both with named cases and figures, and then qualify the political limb with host-country mandate and incentive constraints.

Demand decoding: The directive **comment** requires a direct position on "Comment with examples on the proposition that the Indian diaspora has a decisive role to play...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Decisive is a strong word that the evidence only partly supports, so the comment must separate economic contribution from political effect, evidence both with named cases and figures, and then qualify the political limb with host-country mandate and incentive constraints.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's

inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Decisive is a strong word that the evidence only partly supports, so the comment must separate economic contribution from political effect, evidence both with named cases and figures, and then qualify the political limb with host-country mandate and incentive constraints.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Comment with examples on the proposition that the Indian diaspora has a decisive role to play...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Describe the economic and political benefits for India of the Indian diaspora's rise in the West. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Description must still be organised and bounded, so the answer must set out population, economic and political benefit streams with dated evidence, and close by noting that the same rise creates a protection obligation rather than a costless gain.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments.
- The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence.
- Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community.
- Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away.

Qualified conclusion: Description must still be organised and bounded, so the answer must set out population, economic and political benefit streams with dated evidence, and close by noting that the same rise creates a protection obligation rather than a costless gain.

Demand decoding: The directive **describe** requires a direct position on "Describe the economic and political benefits for India of the Indian diaspora's rise in the...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Description must still be organised and bounded, so the answer must set out population, economic and political benefit streams with dated evidence, and close by noting that the same rise creates a protection obligation rather than a costless gain.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners separate Non-Resident Indians, who are Indian citizens residing abroad, from Persons of Indian Origin and Overseas Citizen of India cardholders, who are foreign nationals of Indian origin, and from labour migrants especially in the Gulf, and the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records 35,421,987 overseas Indians comprising 19,571,375 Non-Resident Indians and 15,850,612 Persons of Indian Origin, with the United States at 6,079,221, the United Arab Emirates at 4,344,008, Malaysia at 2,902,370 and Saudi Arabia at 2,750,551; the owners require every one of these to be described as a population-stock estimate and never as a count of citizens abroad or of Overseas Citizen of India cards issued, because the categories carry different rights and different policy instruments. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Economic Survey 2025-26 records India as the world's largest recipient of remittances, with inflows rising from USD 55.6 billion in the financial year 2011 to USD 135.4 billion provisional in the financial year 2025, about 3.5 per cent of gross domestic product, and USD 73 billion in the first half of the financial year 2026 against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier; the owners admit these as dated evidence of the diaspora's economic weight while routing the macroeconomic mechanics to the Economy owner, and they warn that remittance data must never be substituted for the political half of a question that asks about political influence. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is India's flagship diaspora-engagement event recognising diaspora contributions and setting engagement priorities, and the owners record its most recent verified edition exactly: the eighteenth edition was held from 8-10 January 2025 at Bhubaneswar in Odisha under the theme Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat, with no nineteenth edition officially recorded as held or announced as of 3 August 2026; the discipline attached is that a dated edition must be cited rather than an undated claim of diaspora engagement, and that the absence of a recorded next edition is stated honestly rather than implied away. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Description must still be organised and bounded, so the answer must set out population, economic and political benefit streams with dated evidence, and close by noting that the same rise creates a

protection obligation rather than a costless gain.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Describe the economic and political benefits for India of the Indian diaspora's rise in the...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine why India's diaspora-welfare instruments no longer match the fastest-growing segment of the diaspora. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The mismatch is structural rather than a funding shortfall, so the examination must describe the clearance-based architecture, evidence the composition shift with source shares, and recommend instruments matched to the skilled segment's actual constraints.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things.
- The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments.
- The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight.
- The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment.

Qualified conclusion: The mismatch is structural rather than a funding shortfall, so the examination must describe the clearance-based architecture, evidence the composition shift with source shares, and recommend instruments matched to the skilled segment's actual constraints.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine why India's diaspora-welfare instruments no longer match the fastest-growing segment...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The mismatch is structural rather than a funding shortfall, so the examination must describe the clearance-based architecture, evidence the composition shift with source shares, and recommend instruments matched to the skilled segment's actual constraints.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Three operational welfare instruments sit alongside MADAD: the Indian Community Welfare Fund supports emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid; e-Migrate registers and clears Emigration-Check-Required workers and routes grievances to MADAD; and the Pravasi Bharatiya Bima Yojana is compulsory insurance for Emigration-Check-Required workers going to Emigration-Check-Required countries, providing ten lakh rupees of accidental-death and permanent-disability cover, with 8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025; the owners require the beneficiary and claim figures to be cited with their exact cut-off, because a cumulative coverage figure and a settled-claim figure measure different things. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The Reserve Bank of India's sixth Survey on Remittances for the financial year 2024, reported in the Economic Survey 2025-26, records that advanced economies now contribute more of India's inward remittances than the Gulf Cooperation Council countries, with the United States the top source at 27.7 per cent, followed by the United Arab Emirates at 19.2, the United Kingdom at 10.8 and Singapore at 6.6; the owners treat this as analytically consequential rather than as a statistic, because the diaspora's economic centre of gravity is moving from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration, which changes which host-country relationships carry the greatest consular and negotiating weight. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** The owners identify a structural gap distinct from any resourcing problem: the compulsory-insurance and emigration-clearance stack is tied to the Emigration-Check-Required category and therefore to low-wage Gulf migration, while the fastest-growing remittance base is skilled professional migration to advanced economies whose binding constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition rather than emigration clearance; the examinable consequence is that an answer recommending better diaspora policy must name the mismatch and propose instruments matched to the segment, instead of proposing more of an instrument that does not reach that segment. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit,

trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The mismatch is structural rather than a funding shortfall, so the examination must describe the clearance-based architecture, evidence the composition shift with source shares, and recommend instruments matched to the skilled segment's actual constraints.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine why India's diaspora-welfare instruments no longer match the fastest-growing segment...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the claim that India's soft power is constrained more by institutional fragmentation than by external competition. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The claim is largely defensible but needs both limbs, so the examination must state the fragmentation critique precisely, add the authenticity argument as a second internal constraint, evidence the instruments that do work, and note their regional concentration.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer.
- Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change.
- Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection.
- The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening

event.

Qualified conclusion: The claim is largely defensible but needs both limbs, so the examination must state the fragmentation critique precisely, add the authenticity argument as a second internal constraint, evidence the instruments that do work, and note their regional concentration.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the claim that India's soft power is constrained more by institutional fragmentation...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The claim is largely defensible but needs both limbs, so the examination must state the fragmentation critique precisely, add the authenticity argument as a second internal constraint, evidence the instruments that do work, and note their regional concentration.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor lists Bollywood cinema, books and music, educational opportunities, health care, sporting exchanges, tourism and cultural schemes, alongside Ayurveda and yoga and the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora, as the components of India's soft power, and the owners use this inventory as the precise vocabulary for the cultural-projection track; the discipline is that soft power must be evidenced through this named inventory and the institutions that carry it rather than asserted as a general national attractiveness, because a vague claim of cultural influence earns nothing in an answer. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor argues that effective leveraging of soft power must be done by making its promotion integral to the work of the substantive territorial divisions rather than leaving it solely to umbrella entities like the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and the public diplomacy division, and the owners treat this as a structural institutional-design critique rather than a resourcing complaint; the qualification is that mainstreaming promotion across every geographic desk is a documented proposal and not an implemented reform, so an answer must present it as the analytical spine for a how-should-India-improve question and not as an accomplished institutional change. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** The Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and that it has been an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region, which the owners use to show that a technical-training programme doubles as a soft-power instrument; the limit is explicit and frequently missed, because the survey itself flags the South Asian region as where the cultural-diplomacy effect is strongest, so the effect is not uniform across all partner countries and the programme must not be confused with Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, which is a diaspora-recognition convening event. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen

diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The claim is largely defensible but needs both limbs, so the examination must state the fragmentation critique precisely, add the authenticity argument as a second internal constraint, evidence the instruments that do work, and note their regional concentration.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the claim that India's soft power is constrained more by institutional fragmentation...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the proposition that the diaspora should be treated as a two-way bridge rather than a foreign-policy lever. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Bridge and lever imply different policies, so the assessment must show why instrumentalising citizens abroad creates host-country risk, evidence the reciprocal obligations India already carries, and close on a graded verdict about credibility.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community.
- Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection.
- Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster

Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06.

- The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on.

Qualified conclusion: Bridge and lever imply different policies, so the assessment must show why instrumentalising citizens abroad creates host-country risk, evidence the reciprocal obligations India already carries, and close on a graded verdict about credibility.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the proposition that the diaspora should be treated as a two-way bridge rather than a...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Bridge and lever imply different policies, so the assessment must show why instrumentalising citizens abroad creates host-country risk, evidence the reciprocal obligations India already carries, and close on a graded verdict about credibility.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Indian-origin public figures have held prominent elected offices in developed democracies, including Kamala Harris as United States Vice-President from 2021 to 2025 and Rishi Sunak as United Kingdom Prime Minister from 2022 to 2024, the 119th Congress included six Indian-American members of the House of Representatives, and scholarship on the 2005 to 2008 India-United States civil-nuclear initiative identifies Indian-American organisations as contributors to coalition-building with United States business and strategic constituencies; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that office-holders act under host-country mandates and cannot be treated as agents of India, that party, constituency and committee incentives shape positions more than ancestry, that advocacy contributed to but did not independently determine Congressional approval, and that diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute can turn a community connection into a sovereignty, law-enforcement and trust problem in which allegations, charges, pleas and final judicial findings must be kept distinct and never generalised to a community. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor attributes soft-power damage to India's own domestic failures, citing a nativist attack episode, and argues that soft power will not come from a narrow or restricted version of Indianness and must instead proudly reflect the multi-religious identities of our people and our linguistic diversity, which the owners convert into the rule that soft power is shaped by domestic conduct and not only by external promotion; the analytical sharpening is that the relationship is asymmetric, because a single domestic incident inconsistent with the plural self-image can disproportionately damage cumulative investment in cultural projection. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic

consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners state flatly that Overseas Citizen of India status is not dual citizenship but a specific set of rights and benefits for persons of Indian origin who hold foreign citizenship, and they route the precise legal doctrine to the Polity owner rather than restating it here; the examinable consequence is that an answer must not describe the diaspora as though it enjoyed a second Indian citizenship, because that single error changes what the state may lawfully do for those persons abroad and misstates the entitlement that consular protection actually rests on. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Bridge and lever imply different policies, so the assessment must show why instrumentalising citizens abroad creates host-country risk, evidence the reciprocal obligations India already carries, and close on a graded verdict about credibility.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the proposition that the diaspora should be treated as a two-way bridge rather than a...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess how consular protection converts a diaspora relationship into a standing obligation of the Indian state. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Obligation is legal, institutional and demonstrated, so the assessment must move from the treaty frame through the welfare stack and caseload to a dated evacuation, and must state precisely what the state can and cannot do abroad.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release.
- The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as

evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community.

- Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06.
- The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments.

Qualified conclusion: Obligation is legal, institutional and demonstrated, so the assessment must move from the treaty frame through the welfare stack and caseload to a dated evacuation, and must state precisely what the state can and cannot do abroad.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess how consular protection converts a diaspora relationship into a standing obligation of...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Obligation is legal, institutional and demonstrated, so the assessment must move from the treaty frame through the welfare stack and caseload to a dated evacuation, and must state precisely what the state can and cannot do abroad.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The United Nations Audiovisual Library of International Law page on the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, checked live on 2026-09-03, records that the United Nations Conference on Consular Relations was held at Vienna from 4 March to 22 April 1963 and attended by delegates of ninety-five States, that on 24 April 1963 the Conference adopted and opened for signature the Convention together with the Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes, that the Convention and both Optional Protocols came into force on 19 March 1967, and that the Convention consists of 79 articles of which Article 36 provides obligations for competent authorities on the arrest or detention of a foreign national so as to guarantee counsel and due process through consular notification and effective access to consular protection; the owners add the limit in the same place, namely that this is a reciprocal treaty right and a procedural safeguard and not an unlimited power to override host-country law or secure release. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Ministry of External Affairs recorded 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad in a Lok Sabha answer dated 28 March 2025, which the owners treat as a measure of consular workload rather than of diaspora wrongdoing, and they pair it with the population stock of 35,421,987 overseas Indians to show that welfare and protection capacity operates at a very large scale; the qualification is that capacity and reach limitations are a genuine ongoing operational challenge rather than a solved problem, so an answer should treat the caseload as evidence of obligation rather than as a criticism of the community. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel, and the owners treat it as the dated worked example

of crisis evacuation, which is qualitatively different from routine consular welfare because it requires host-government negotiation and consular readiness before any aircraft moves; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the diplomatic architecture that enables an evacuation belongs to this folder while the relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner, and the Gulf regional exposure that generates such crises belongs to topic 06. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Protector General of Emigrants is the Ministry of External Affairs authority overseeing emigration clearance and protection of migrant workers, particularly for Emigration-Check-Required categories heading to specified countries, and the owners treat the clearance category as the legal hinge of the welfare track because it determines who is covered by compulsory insurance and mandatory registration; the analytical point is that a protection architecture organised around a clearance category protects exactly the population inside that category and leaves everyone outside it to a different and thinner set of instruments. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Obligation is legal, institutional and demonstrated, so the assessment must move from the treaty frame through the welfare stack and caseload to a dated evacuation, and must state precisely what the state can and cannot do abroad.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess how consular protection converts a diaspora relationship into a standing obligation of...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.